of some animals out of Bewick and other books. He does not want any more just now and I hope he won't want any more of them but give me other work to do, for I am not fond of these animals, it appears to me such childish sort of work.

We have had an English traveller here lately, and as since the Egyptian rout was opened between England and India, they are very rare, we are much pleased to see them. His name Mr Joseph Tasker. I know nothing about his family except that they are Catholic, and have a place in Essex. He has been travelling some years in Turkey and Arabia. I am sorry he comes to Persia in such a bad season for of all countries to visit in the winter, Persia is the worst, and he has gone into one of the coldest districts viz Koordistan, so he won't learn much of the country. Like most travellers he is travelling more to look after the antiquities than any thing else. I believe he intends to travel over a great part of Persia, and so I hope he may be in the country in spring summer and autumn also, as I should be sorry any one should return to Europe, with such an idea of this country as he would get from a winter tour in it.

I keep my health well in all this cold, and as we hear nothing of the cholera in this province we hope that we have done with it, and that it may not appear again next year. It seems to have gone to the Northward as it has declared itself in the Russian Trans-Caucasian provinces. God grant it may not reach Europe and approach you.

[EDWARD BURGESS TO GEORGE BURGESS] *Tabreez, July 6, 1847*

Has the immense trade there has been in grain lately to Europe, brought nothing to you? I hoped as you were connected with America you might have got some good commissions.

Mr Stevens now our consul here, has gained nothing by his appointment. He was vice consul at Samsoon on the Black Sea with 300 a year pay and liberty to trade; he was agent for the British steamers and that and his trade, cleared him after paying all expenses upwards of two thousand pounds the last year he was there. His trade was chiefly buying grain and Valonia (acorn cups used in dyeing) for the merchants at Constantinople. But being in partnership with Brants house which had branches at Erzeroom and Kaiseria, which are losing concerns, his profits went to make up the losses. Here he has £600 a year and no trade. And as the expenses of this consulate are much heavier than that of Samsoon I do not think he saves anything. But I believe he could not refuse the appointment without quitting the service. The place here is much higher in point of station and consideration, our consuls here being like little ambassadors.

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